

Chapter 133-3

Shen Hui's voice carried a hint of amusement, sounding flippant and casual: "That Zhao Xuning, she's just pretending. Her life has been too smooth sailing—everyone has been holding her up on a pedestal since she was little. Even when the two of us dated, I was the one who took the initiative. She's completely fake-serious. If I had to describe her in one word, it would be—outwardly cold but inwardly passionate."¹

The private room instantly fell silent.

Liang Shi and Zhao Xuning looked at each other in dismay, then simultaneously looked toward the source of the voice.

Xu Qingzhu cleared her throat lightly, "Um, well, I was chatting with Shen Hui."

Zhao Xuning: "....."

Now Zhao Xuning had nothing to say. She took on the stance of absolutely having to drink Liang Shi under the table.

The two of them didn't eat much food, but drank quite a lot of wine.

The original body couldn't hold her liquor well, but Liang Shi could.

Especially since Liang Shi was in a good mood today—she drank without any hesitation, going back and forth with Zhao Xuning.

In the end, Zhao Xuning collapsed on the table, and before passing out drunk, she still cursed: "Liang Shi, you're really annoying tonight."

Liang Shi chuckled lightly, the corners of her eyes tinged with red, and said with a bit of drunkenness: "I told you I can drink. I can do it."

After she finished speaking, she heard a laugh ring out in the private room—a cool voice carrying a touch of tenderness, very soft.

Yet it made Liang Shi's ears itch.

Liang Shi pinched her ear, and with somewhat hazy eyes, looked toward Xu Qingzhu.

"What are you laughing at?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu rubbed her nose, the corners of her mouth turning up, "Laughing at you."

Liang Shi: "....."

"You're so annoying." Liang Shi had learned a new phrase from Zhao Xuning and immediately put it to use, though her tone was reproachful and sounded like she was acting spoiled. She leaned closer to Xu Qingzhu and pinched her face, "Are you mocking me?"

"No." Xu Qingzhu refuted: "How could I?"

Liang Shi: "Then why are you laughing?"

"Because you're cute." Xu Qingzhu had also drunk quite a bit.

She sat there listening to them chat, though sometimes the two didn't even chat—they just clinked glasses, raised them, and drank.

Anyone who didn't know better would think they were drowning some deep sorrow.

In reality, it was probably one being competitive and one being heartbroken.

Xu Qingzhu, on the other hand, was purely happy.

After so many days of her heart hanging in suspense, it had finally settled down. The person she had been longing for had returned.

How wonderful.

Xu Qingzhu found drinking by herself quite enjoyable too.

The snow falling outside was beautiful, the lights in the private room were lovely, and everything was full of vitality.

The world in her eyes seemed to have a soft-focus filter over it.

Xu Qingzhu's eyes were like a little deer's, carrying a dewy quality that made one's heart flutter.

Liang Shi stared at her, and after a moment, leaned in and kissed her on those rippling, glistening lips.

Then she reached out and ruffled her hair.

Liang Shi chuckled softly, her voice very low, "Not as cute as you."

Xu Qingzhu's hand fell on her forehead, a smile blooming on her face, yet she gently pushed her away, "Where did you learn all this?"

Liang Shi: "From you."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Xu Qingzhu pinched her waist, "Learning bad habits."

"You're so good." Liang Shi had obviously drunk too much. After drinking with Zhao Xuning all evening, there were too many empty wine bottles beside them to count. When she spoke now, her eyes blinked rapidly, looking both earnest and cute, "How is it learning bad habits?"

Liang Shi's hand fell on Xu Qingzhu's waist, but she couldn't bear to pinch her—she just gently caressed with her fingertips.

Her tone lilted upward slightly, sounding tantalizing to the ears, "Everything I learn from you is good."

Footnotes:

¹ "悶騷" (mèn sāo) - A Chinese slang term describing someone who appears cold, reserved, or serious on the outside, but is actually passionate, wild, or romantic on the inside. It's often used to describe someone who hides their true feelings or desires beneath a composed exterior.